IT Security Guideline for Employees

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Rheintal Antriebstechnik GmbH

1. Purpose and scope

This guideline defines the minimum security rules for everyone who uses IT systems of Rheintal Antriebstechnik GmbH: employees, working students, interns and external contractors. It implements the requirements of ISO/IEC 27001 and the TISAX assessment level 2. Violations may lead to disciplinary action.

2. Passwords and authentication

Rule	Requirement
Minimum password length	14 characters
Complexity	At least three of: upper case, lower case, digits, symbols
Rotation	No forced rotation; change immediately if compromise is suspected
Reuse	The last 10 passwords cannot be reused
Multi-factor authentication	Mandatory for VPN, e-mail, ERP and all cloud services
Password manager	Only the company-approved manager (Bitwarden Teams)

Passwords must never be shared, written on paper or stored in browsers. Shared accounts are prohibited except for documented technical service accounts owned by IT Operations.

3. Devices and remote work

Only company-managed devices enrolled in the mobile device management system may access internal systems. Devices lock automatically after 5 minutes of inactivity. Hard disks are encrypted with BitLocker or FileVault. Private USB storage devices are blocked; approved encrypted USB sticks can be requested from the IT service desk.

When working remotely, always connect through the company VPN. Public Wi-Fi may only be used with the VPN active. Confidential documents must not be printed at home or in hotels.

4. E-mail and phishing

Check the sender address and hover over links before clicking. Report suspicious e-mails with the 'Report Phishing' button in Outlook; do not forward them. Never open macros in Office documents from external senders. The IT service desk will never ask for your password by e-mail or phone.

5. Data classification

Class	Examples	Handling
Public	Brochures, published data sheets	No restrictions
Internal	Organisation charts, process descriptions	Company network and MDM devices
Confidential	Drawings, prices, customer data	Encrypted storage and transfer
Strictly confidential	M&A; documents, source code of control firmware	Named access list, no cloud storage, no printing

6. Use of AI tools

Public AI chat services may be used for public and internal information only. Confidential or strictly confidential data, personal data and customer drawings must not be entered into public AI services. For such data use the internal DocuMind assistant, which runs on company infrastructure. Generated code must be reviewed before it is committed.

7. Incident reporting

Report any suspected security incident, lost device or data leak immediately to the IT service desk at extension 4444 or security@rheintal-antriebstechnik.example, at the latest within 24 hours. Lost or stolen devices are wiped remotely. Do not try to investigate incidents yourself.

8. Software and updates

Only software from the company software portal may be installed. Security updates are installed automatically; devices that have not been updated for more than 30 days lose network access until they are patched. Local administrator rights are granted only on request for a maximum of 90 days.

9. Review

This guideline is reviewed annually by the information security officer. The next review is due in February 2027.